

CLASS 10 POWER SHARING NOTES

BY

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CH 1 Political Science - Notes

Power sharing - Division of power among different peoples in different forms like among different organs of govt. , different social groups , different levels of govt. etc.

Needs of Power Sharing / Why Power sharing is Desirable

Prudential reasons (based on careful calculations and facts) -

- **Helps reduce conflict between social groups** since these conflicts often leads to violence and political instability , power sharing also helps to ensure stability of political order.
- Helps in unity of the nation since all groups are enjoys some powers.

Moral reasons:

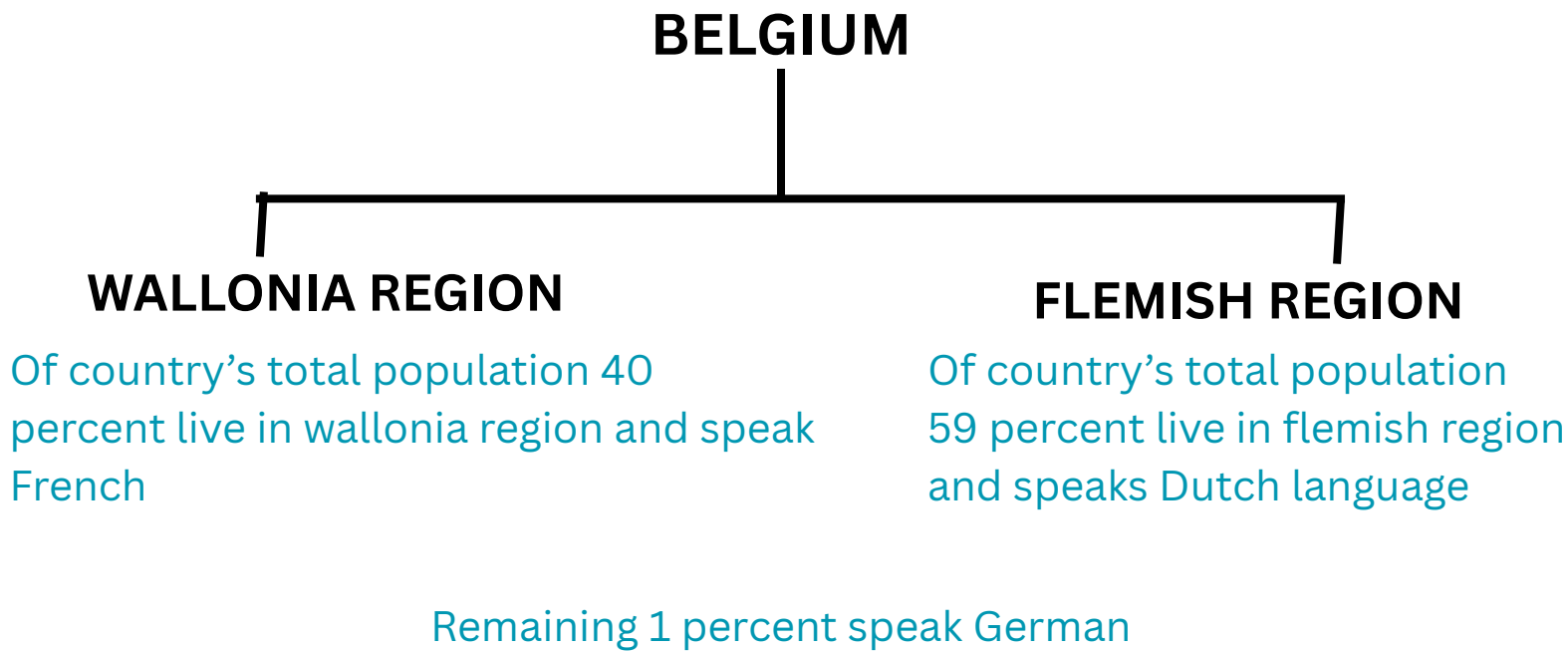
- **Power sharing is the spirit of Democracy** as power sharing ensure the principle of sharing power with those affected by it exercise and who have to life with its effects.

Prudential reasons stress that power sharing will bring out better outcomes while moral reason emphasize the very act of power sharing as valuable.

Power shairng in Belgium

Belgium is a small country in Europe. It shares border with France , the Netherlands , Luxembourg and Germany.

Ethnic composition (social division based on shared culture) of this small country is ver complex.



In capital city Brussels 80 percent speak French while 20 percent speak dutch . Minority French speaking community was relatively rich and powerful .This led to tension between dutch-speaking and french-speaking communities during 1950s-1960s.

Tensions between the communities was more acute in Brussels where majority dutch speaking of the country was in minority.

Accommodation in Belgium

To solve these arising conflicts belgian leaders amended their constitution four times so as to work out an arrangement that would enable everyone to live together with the same country.

Some of the elements of the belgian model are -

- Number of dutch and french speaking ministers shall be equal in central govt. and some laws require support of majority of members from each linguistic group enabling no single community to make decisions only by themselves.
- Many powers of Central govt. was given to state govt. of the two regions of the country and the state govt. were not subordinate to the central govt.
- Brussels also a seperate govt. in which like central govt. both communities have equal representation.
- A new community govt. was formed which belongs to one language community and exercise power regarding cultural , educational and language related issues.

Majoritarianism in Sri Lanka

Sri lanka is an island nation just a few kilometers off the southern coast of Tamil Nadu . Major social groups of Sri Lanka are Sinhala-speaker(74 percent) and Tamil speaker (18 percent)

Tamil are divided into two groups sri lankan tamils (13 percent) and indian tamil whose forefathers come from india as plantation workers during colonial period.

Sri Lankan Tamils are concentrated in the north and east of the country and are mostly hindus or muslims while sinhala-speaking were mostly buddhists. There are also 7 percent Christians who are both Tamil and Sinhala.

Sri Lanka emerged as an independent country in 1948 , as sinhala was in

majority it forms dominance over govt. and follow majoritarianism (a belief that majority community can rule minority in whichever ways it wants by disregarding wishes and needs of minority)

Some measures taken by Srilankan govt are -

- In 1956 an Act was passed which recognise Sinhala as the only official language .
- Govt. followed policies that favoured sinhala applicants for university position and govt. jobs .
- A new constitution said that state should protect and foster buddhism.

These govt. measures make Tamils feel separated from the govt. They felt that govt. and constitution denied them equal political right , discriminated against them and ignored their interests .

Srilankan launched parties and struggle demanding for -

- Recognition of Tamil as an official language
- equality of opportunity in securing education and jobs.

When these demands were denied several political organisations were formed demanding an independent state for Tamils in eastern and southern parts of Srilanka.

These results in a civil war in which thousands of people dies , many families were forced to leave the county as refugees and many more lost their livelihoods. It ended in 2009.

Forms of Power-sharing

In a democracy everyone should have a voice in shaping of public policies and due respect must be give to diverse groups and views that exist in a society . Therefore , **In a democracy political power should be distributed among as many citizens as possible .**

In modern democracies this takes the form of many arrangements .Some of the most common are-

- Among different organs of govt. such as legislature , executive and judiciary . **This is called horizontal distribution of power because it allows differnet organs of govt. placed at same level to exercise different power.** Such seperation ensure none of the organs can exercise unlimited power. **This arrangement is called a system of checks and balances.**
- Among govt. at different levels . A govt. at general govt. which is called federal govt. , in India we called them Central or Union govt and govt. at provincial or regional level. Different levels of govt. are not follow in all countries but where they are followed like Belgium the powers of different levels of govt. are clearly specified in constitution. This is called Federal division of power. Such division is called vertical division of power

- Among different social groups such as community govt. in Belgium.
Some countries have made legal arrangements for women and socially weaker sections representation in legislatures and administration . Such differences are used for minority communities to give them a fair share in power otherwise they might get alienated from the govt.
- Among political parties , pressure groups and movements on how they control and influence those in power .
Eg- coalition government.

THANK YOU !